



LIZ WAGNER, Project Street Vet operations manager, checks on a man and his dog on Skid Row in July.

Political leaders at odds as AI fears spread

President Trump blames the backlash on a ‘conspiracy’ perpetuated by China.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Monday forcefully rejected calls to slow the development of artificial intelligence, dismissing concerns about its risks as a “hoax” and warning the United States remains locked in a fierce technological race with China.

The president’s position has put him at odds with a growing chorus of industry leaders and bipartisan lawmakers warning that AI could soon advance beyond human control.

Top executives from three of the country’s leading AI companies — OpenAI’s Sam Altman, Anthropic’s Dario Amodei and SpaceX’s Elon Musk — issued exceptional calls this past weekend for collaboration on a path forward that could “pace the frontier” of AI development.

Rare flashes of bipartisanship have also emerged on Capitol Hill, where Senate Majority Leader John Thune, a Republican, is working with Democrats on legislation aimed at guarding against AI’s most catastrophic risks, including its potential use to develop biological weapons.

And Democratic elders, including former President Obama and former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton, have urged their party to treat the threats posed by AI as an acute national security crisis.

[See AI, A6]

Talk of pause hits tech stocks hard

AI chiefs call for slowing advances, but others in industry reject doomsday scenarios. **BUSINESS, A9**

A fight over the plight of dogs on Skid Row

By SANDRA McDONALD AND JENNY JARVIE

In the heart of Skid Row on a hot summer afternoon, Amber Willard pushed a skinny brown and white pit bull named Athena on a rolling office chair.

Victoriah Bech Parker, founder of the Starts With One Today animal rescue group, offered the dog a bowl of wet food.

“You don’t look too good,” Bech Parker cooed as she bent down to pet Athena with a gloved hand. The dog’s ribs poked out, her skin was irritated and red, and patches of fur were missing — a possible sign of mange.

Willard, an unhoused woman originally from Alaska, said she hadn’t been on Skid Row long: Her landlord had suddenly kicked her out. She wanted a dog for companionship and protection, she said, and got Athena for free from a man on a corner a few days before. She said she had tried to bathe Athena, but declined

Bech Parker’s offer of a free vet appointment.

As Willard wheeled Athena away, fussing with an umbrella to offer the dog shade, Bech Parker shook her head in frustration.

“That dog really needs some proper care,” Bech Parker said.

Athena is just one of the dogs Bech Parker and other activists hope to save as they warn that a full-blown animal crisis is unfolding on Skid Row.

On social media and in legal filings, animal advocates complain that the 50-block zone in downtown Los Angeles that’s home to thousands of unhoused people is an epicenter of animal neglect and cruelty. City officials, they say, are failing to enforce animal welfare laws. Many dogs, like Athena, are malnourished and have [See Dogs, A14]



ALEX GALLARDO Associated Press

HARRIS, left, shown in 2023, and Newsom have never run for the same office.

Newsom won’t battle Harris

‘I wouldn’t run if she ran’ for president in ’28, he says

By JUSTINE MCDANIEL

WASHINGTON — Gov. Gavin Newsom said he would not run for the Democratic presidential nomination in 2028 if Kamala Harris does so, appearing to offer deference to the former vice president ahead of a race that could draw a historically crowded field of candidates.

“I wouldn’t run if she ran,” Newsom told CNN’s Jake Tapper in an interview posted Monday. “Why would

I? I wouldn’t do that to her. ... I wouldn’t do it to you, I wouldn’t waste everyone’s time.”

Newsom appeared to acknowledge a desire to avoid the possibly messy fight for California backers that could ensue if both were to run, saying there would be “pure crossover” between Harris’ supporters and his.

The governor’s effective yield to Harris diminishes the possibility of a showdown between two of California’s most powerful political figures in an elec-

tion whose stakes are viewed by the Democratic Party as existential. The possibility of Harris making a second attempt at the presidency after her loss to President Trump in 2024 has hung as the biggest question over the potential Democratic field.

Both Newsom and Harris have acknowledged they are considering presidential bids in 2028, but Harris has closely held her intentions. She said last week that she had not decided whether to run, telling former soccer [See Newsom, A7]

Supreme Court halts Trump’s proposed limits on mail ballots

Decision is a victory for California and 22 other states that sued to block new rules.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE AND KEVIN RECTOR

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court has blocked President Trump’s plan to restrict voting by mail, ruling it is too late to impose new U.S. Postal Service rules for the November election.

The justices on Monday turned down an emergency appeal from Trump’s lawyers, who argued the government needed a new and untested system of unique barcodes to track all the ballots of the tens of millions of people who vote by mail. Instead, the justices left

in place a judge’s order that prevents the Postal Service from enforcing the new rules for the midterm elections.

Concurring, Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh agreed it was too late to enforce the new rules for this election.

Justices Samuel A. Alito Jr. and Clarence Thomas dissented.

The decision in USPS vs. California is a victory for California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta and the attorneys general for 22 other Democrat-led states who sued to block the new rules.

Last week, they warned there would be chaos and confusion if Trump’s rules were put in effect now.

Bonta cheered the decision late Monday, calling it “a victory for our democracy and a powerful affirmation of the rule of law” in a case [See Ballots, A7]

EPA removes curbs on power plant emissions

Agency cites energy costs, but experts say sweeping rollback will drive climate change.

By HAYLEY SMITH AND BLANCA BEGERT

The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency said Monday it will no longer regulate planet-warming pollution from power plants that burn coal or natural gas.

The nation’s top environmental authority is rolling back most Biden-era limits on greenhouse gas emissions in an effort to remove “red tape” that drives up energy costs, agency officials said. They also announced a proposal to rescind regulations on the power sector from the Obama era and prevent future administrations from implementing new ones.

Making electricity from coal and gas is the second-largest source of greenhouse gas emissions in the U.S. and the leading driver of climate

change globally.

“For over 15 years, the Obama and Biden administrations implemented a war on coal to destroy reliable and affordable energy,” EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin said in a statement. “The Trump Administration has come in to protect American energy and to make sure you can afford to keep the lights on.”

But experts say unchecked greenhouse gas emissions from power plants mean more global warming and set back progress on climate change across the U.S. California does not have any coal-fired power plants and has its own regulations on natural gas.

The rollback could result in as much as 5.8 billion metric tons of added carbon dioxide emissions by 2050, said Zealan Hoover, a former senior advisor to the EPA administrator in the Biden administration.

While electricity demand is rising, “we do not have to meet that electricity demand by highly polluting coal and gas plants,” Hoover [See Rollback, A7]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

THE EMMYS

Mariska Hargitay (with daughter Amaya Hermann), a winner herself, arrives to host. Scan the code to read our coverage of the ceremony.



States sue over green card rules

Democratic officials say Trump administration can’t reject applicants because of past use of public aid. **NATION, A4**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 83/66. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

Bob Mackie, designer to stars

The fashion legend known for his elaborate creations has died. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.



7 85944 00200 5

With Ballmer’s apology, Clippers can move on

By KEVIN BAXTER

Clippers owner Steve Ballmer and his staff had spent the last 12 months loudly insisting they’d done nothing wrong.

The podcast “Pablo Torre Finds Out” first raised questions about payments star forward Kawhi Leonard received from Aspiration

Partners without doing any endorsement work to benefit the company on Sept. 3, 2025. The NBA responded by starting an investigation.

In its findings — released Sept. 2 — an independent law firm reported “a pattern of misconduct and multiple significant rules violations” that benefited Leonard, who received \$66 million in cash and equity from four compa-

nies through agreements facilitated by Ballmer and team executives at the request of Leonard’s uncle and then-agent. Those deals violated the league salary cap, which limits how much teams can pay players. The cap is \$164.961 million for the coming season.

The Clippers released two statements that same day, protesting the finding

and the stiffest sanctions in NBA history, including a \$30-million fine and the loss of five future first-round draft picks. In addition, Ballmer, 69, was banned from all league activities for the next year.

After immediately calling the NBA’s investigation “biased” and vowing to “vigorously challenge these find-

[See Clippers, A11]